From: Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>
To: Andy Lyne <Andy.Lyne@qlaims.com>
CC: Claims <Claims@qlaims.com>, Louisa Scarr <scarrlouisa@gmail.com>
Date: Thursday 02 October 2025 at 14:17
Subject: Sewage contamination at 1 Riverside Cottages – Full disposal, replacement, and redecoration required

Dear Andy,

Further to our discussions and site attendances, I want to set out in clear terms why full disposal, replacement, and redecoration are required at 1 Riverside Cottages. The position is based on established facts on site, BioResponse's professional statements, medical opinion, and recognised standards for Category 3 (sewage) contamination.

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Why full disposal and redecoration is unavoidable

• For nearly five months the house was left to marinate in sewage under conditions of high humidity. This ensured that airborne pathogens penetrated deeply into the building fabric. The consequences for porous materials and finishes are severe.

• Following the strip-out, the lavatory was removed and an open soil pipe in the centre of the house was left exposed. This pipe connects directly into the main Alresford sewer, which carries the bulk of the town's sewage only metres from the property.

• BioResponse then ran blowers and dehumidifiers throughout the house, using this exposed soil pipe as the dehumidifier drain. The result was that sewer air was actively drawn up from the main town sewer and blown around the entire property, upstairs and downstairs, within a metre of the kitchen units.

• This was not passive seepage — it was the forced circulation of sewage-laden air into every surface, cavity, and item in the house.

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Professional confirmation and medical opinion

• At a meeting with BioResponse, Darren of BioResponse confirmed to me — with you attending by telephone — that there is no economically viable method of effectively testing for the elimination of pathogens from affected materials.

• It was also made clear that a surface swab only reports on the exact spot tested at that moment in time; it cannot evidence safety elsewhere in the same item or across the wider property. The suggested approach of applying disinfectant and then using an ATP swab as "proof" is not scientifically valid for systemic or embedded contamination.

• Dr Vanya Gant's letter confirms the property must not be re-occupied until restored to a condition equivalent to hospital sterilisation standards.

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Long-term pathogen persistence and infiltration

• Independent evidence shows sewage-associated organisms (Ascaris, Trichuris, Toxoplasma gondii, Cryptosporidium, Giardia, C. difficile, adenoviruses) can survive for months and, in some cases, well over 12 months in moist and porous environments.

• Because the property was left for five months under extreme humidity, pathogens infiltrated deep into plaster, insulation, and timbers — not just surfaces.

• With the open soil pipe connected to the main Alresford sewer and BioResponse's blowers circulating air throughout the house, contamination was forcibly driven into every crevice and absorbent surface.

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Standards and regulatory framework

• Building Regulations (Part C): a dwelling must be free from health risks from contaminants and damp. A property left in sewage for months with forced circulation of sewer air is clearly non-compliant.

• IICRC S500 (Category 3 water): porous materials must be removed and replaced; cleaning is not an acceptable alternative.

• NICEIC / BS 7671: electrical systems exposed to contaminated water must be replaced.

• UKHSA/Public Health England: sewage contains pathogens capable of long-term survival; porous items and finishes cannot be sanitised.

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Required outcomes (minimum safe scope)

• Dispose and replace all porous contents: carpets, underlay, mattresses, bedding, upholstered furniture, curtains/soft furnishings, and contaminated insulation.

• Dispose and replace all kitchen units and joinery exposed within metres of the open sewer connection.

• Strip out and replace contaminated plasterboard and affected timbers.

• Undertake full redecoration of the entire property — both ground floor and first floor — given the pervasive airborne contamination and high humidity over a five-month period.

• Dispose and replace all vented electrical units and systems (sockets, switches, consumer unit, and cabling as required).

• Independent post-remediation verification: to be carried out by a third-party hygienist/environmental specialist with no role in the remediation works. This verification applies only to non-porous or sealed surfaces (e.g. tiles, sealed concrete, metal, glass, plastics), using visual inspection, moisture testing, and accredited laboratory swabs. Porous items cannot be tested and are removed precisely because they cannot be validated as safe. ATP meters are not accepted as proof of clearance.

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Conclusion

In light of the prolonged sewage exposure, the high humidity, the centrally-located open soil pipe connected to the main town sewer, the forced circulation of contaminated air, the professional and medical consensus, the long-term persistence of pathogens, and the standards set by Building Regulations, IICRC, NICEIC/BS 7671, and public health authorities, there is no safe or defensible alternative to the full disposal, replacement, and redecoration programme outlined above.

Please confirm that you will reflect these points in your dealings with the insurer and seek immediate authorisation for the complete scope.

Yours sincerely,

Nicholas Scarr

Sent from my iPad